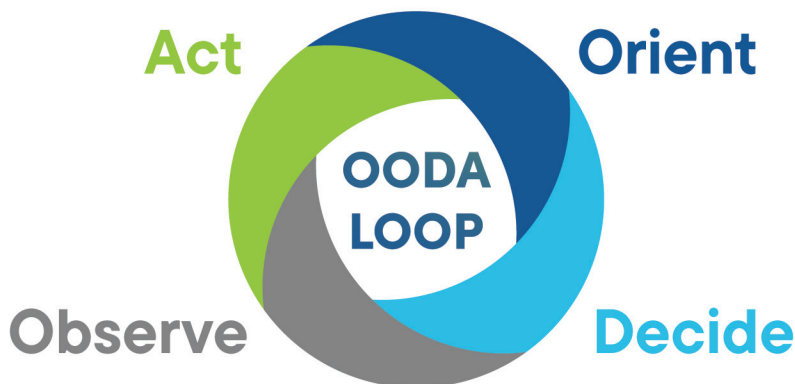


You can use a variety of tools to make proactive decisions while reacting to your environment. One tool is the OODA Loop. It's a loop because every situation leads to another.



1. **Observe.** Observe the situation. What changed? Is there a car swerving, a sudden obstacle, or a change in traffic flow?
2. **Orient.** Use your knowledge and experience to understand what that change means. How does it affect your safety and the safety of others? What are the potential risks if you don't change? What opportunities present themselves if you do?
3. **Decide.** Based on your observations and understanding, choose the safest course of action. Should you slow down, change lanes, or signal your intentions?
4. **Act.** Smoothly and decisively execute your chosen action. Remember, clear communication is crucial for others to understand your intentions.

As you build experience, you will be able to navigate the OODA loop with ease. However, there are many variables when you're driving. You will always need to stay alert and ready.